Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 5♦
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣7

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣K

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠Q

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 5♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣2

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠10

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥8

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ 6 ♥ K 4 ♦ K J 9 7 4 ♣ A Q J 9 2	
♠ Q 10 9 7 2 ♥ A Q J 6 ♦ A 8 ♣ 6 3		♠ J 8 4 3 ♥ 10 9 8 5 3 2 ♦ 2 ♣ 7 5
	♠ A K 5 ♥ 7 ♦ Q 10 6 5 3 ♣ K 10 8 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♦ by North
Lead: ♣7

NORTH thinks slam may be possible, so she uses Blackwood.

And that's what Blackwood is really good for - keeping you out of slams when you are missing two Aces!

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 8 5 2 ♥ 4 3 ♦ K J 10 2 ♣ J 9 6 3	
♠ A Q J 7 3 ♥ A J 8 6 ♦ 5 3 ♣ 8 7		♠ K 4 ♥ K Q 10 9 5 ♦ A 7 6 ♣ A 5 4
	♠ 10 9 6 ♥ 7 2 ♦ Q 9 8 4 ♣ K Q 10 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♠	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♥[2]	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by East
Lead: ♣K

EAST knows WEST has at least five ♠s, and they might provide discards for two or three of her minor suit losers.

She tries Blackwood and, sure enough, WEST comes through with two Aces.

Even with all the Aces EAST knows there are not enough points for Grand, so she bids 6♥.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 6 2 ♥ K Q J 7 ♦ 6 ♣ K Q J 10 9	
♠ Q J 10 9 ♥ 6 4 ♦ Q 8 5 3 ♣ 8 5 3		♠ 8 7 4 ♥ 8 3 ♦ K J 10 7 2 ♣ 7 6 2
	♠ K 5 3 ♥ A 10 9 5 2 ♦ A 9 4 ♣ A 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	Pass	1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	5NT[3]
Pass	7♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace
3. asks for kings

7♥ by South
Lead: ♠Q

When NORTH answers Blackwood with one Ace SOUTH decides to bid 5NT to ask for Kings.

With two Kings, NORTH would bid 6♥. But she knows that if she does so, SOUTH might stop right there.

Knowing the 5NT bid guarantees all four Aces, NORTH figures her ♣ suit will supply five tricks so she bids 7♥.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 9 4 3 ♥ K 3 ♦ J 10 9 8 2 ♣ 9 6 2	
♠ A K Q 5 ♥ A J 6 5 2 ♦ 6 ♣ K Q J	N W E S	♠ 8 7 ♥ Q 9 7 4 ♦ K Q 5 ♣ A 10 8 3
	♠ J 10 6 2 ♥ 10 8 ♦ A 7 4 3 ♣ 7 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]	Pass
5♥			
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♥ by West
Lead: ♣2

WEST thinks there might be slam if EAST holds both minor Aces, so he tries Blackwood.

When EAST shows just one Ace WEST is afraid he will have a trump loser as well, so he stops at 5♥.

It turns out that WEST might make twelve tricks, depending on the ♥K situation.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 6
♥ K 5
♦ A Q 6 2
♣ A 9 7 4

♠ 7 5 3
♥ 6 3
♦ 10 9 5 3
♣ Q 10 8 2



♠ Q 10 9 8
♥ 10 9
♦ J 8 7 4
♣ J 6 5

♠ K 4 2
♥ A Q J 8 7 4 2
♦ K
♣ K 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	5♥	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

7NT by North
Lead: ♠10

SOUTH might be tempted to blast into Blackwood with his first bid, pushing toward some slam in ♥s. He chooses to temporize with a 1♥ response and is rewarded when NORTH jumps to 2NT (18-19 points).

The Notrump bid prevents SOUTH from using Blackwood, but Gerber 4♣ will work just fine. When he discovers that NORTH holds three Aces and one King he can count thirteen tricks.

Board 6
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 10 8 7 5 2 ♥ J 6 ♦ 10 6 4 ♣ 7 4 3	
♠ A K ♥ K Q 4 ♦ K Q J 3 ♣ K Q J 5		♠ Q 6 3 ♥ A 10 7 ♦ 9 5 2 ♣ A 10 8 6
	♠ J 9 4 ♥ 9 8 5 3 2 ♦ A 8 7 ♣ 9 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♠	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

6NT by East
Lead: ♥8

EAST responds 2NT, showing 8+ points with no 5-card suit.

WEST only needs to know how many Aces are in the EAST hand. He must use Gerber since 4NT in this situation would not be Blackwood.

When EAST shows two Aces WEST bids 6NT.